

China Internet

MiniMax Group Inc.

Rating

Market-Perform

Price Target

 **100.HK**

320.00 HKD (275.00 OLD)



Robin Zhu
+852 2123 2659
robin.zhu@bernsteinsg.com



Charles Gou
+852 2123 2618
charles.gou@bernsteinsg.com



Min-Joo Kang
+852 2123 2644
minjoo.kang@bernsteinsg.com

Minimax H1: Higher ARR, lower inference margins

That gross margin... H1 2026 probably counts as ancient history in an environment where the half-life of new AI developments is measured in weeks. But for what it's worth, Minimax's H1 print showed revenue (\$117mn, +283% year on year) falling modestly short of our modeling (\$146mn). Group gross margin (17.9%) fell short of our expectations (31.5%) and what felt like a popular 30% market bogey. Higher R&D spend (\$297mn vs. \$124mn in the prior year period) drove a larger adjusted net loss than we'd modelled (\$293mn vs. \$135mn). Compared with c. \$300mn of cash burn in H1, the company said it had c. \$3bn of cash on hand, including placement proceeds from July.

Explaining the numbers. Among the financial metrics we think are worth scrutinising, ARR-to-revenue conversion was probably "okay", compared with \$400mn of ARR by May. \$42.6mn of AI-native products revenue in H1 was in-line with our modeling, while Open Platform revenues (\$73.9mn) explained the shortfall versus our top-line estimate. A decline in the company's overseas revenue share (60.8% versus 71.8% in H1 2025) was notable. Minimax no longer reports gross profit breakdowns by segment, which complicates any assessment of the different parts of its business. But management arguing in April M2.7 had achieved 40% inference margins lives on in our memory.

Efficiency as a driver of model intelligence...? Management commentary on the quarter featured repeated mentions of inference efficiency as driver of model progress. This surprised us - while better inference efficiency allows Minimax to run more experiments within finite compute and time budgets, we're ultimately of the view that training data and compute, model architecture and scale, expert domain data depth, RL engineering, and eval quality represent more impactful drivers of model intelligence and long-horizon agentic capabilities. Notably, improvements anticipated from M3.1 and M3 Pro were attributed to more extensive pre-training, RL, and long-horizon post-training.

Investment Implications

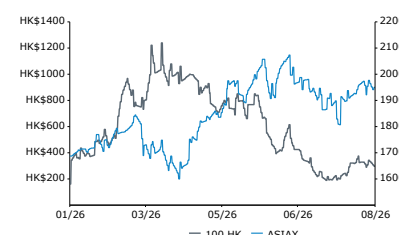
We rate Minimax Market-Perform (PT HK\$320).

Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E	Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR	Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
100.HK (USD)	(2.31)	(2.11)	(2.31)	Revenues (M)	79.04	593.57	2,054	--	Adjusted P/E (x)	(16.7)	(18.3)	(16.8)
OLD	--	(0.97)	(1.36)	Gross Profit (M)	20.08	205.49	709.07	494.3%	EV/EBIT (x)	(0.9)	(2.0)	(1.8)
				Operating Earnings (M)	(281.03)	(761.52)	(915.02)	80.4%	EV/Sales (x)	20.3	2.7	0.8
				Net Earnings (M)	(250.86)	(681.93)	(792.40)	77.7%				

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Close Date	26 Aug 2026			
100.HK Close Price (HKD)	303.00			
Price Target (HKD)	320.00			
Upside/(Downside)	6%			
52-Week Range	1,330.00/186.20			
ASIAx	1,950.18			
FYE	Dec			
Div Yield	NA			
Market Cap (HKD) (M)	105,818			
EV (HKD) (M)	12,590			
Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	NA	54.6	(61.6)	NA
ASIAx (%)	19.2	3.7	5.6	29.2
Relative (%)	NA	50.9	(67.2)	NA
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.				

Price Performance, 1YR



DETAILS

A SOFT BUT VERY BACKWARD-LOOKING PRINT... A LOT NOW HANGS ON M3 PRO

Speaking around the quarter, Minimax management noted that the company's ARR had exceeded \$800mn in August, 80% of which was driven by enterprise (versus 30% a year earlier). This was higher than we'd assumed, and we've raised our go-forward estimates in response. But the company declined to officially raise year-end ARR guidance, given the wide range of potential outcomes for M3 Pro.

User compensation related to M3 was said to have been a drag on H1 2026 gross margin, although the company declined to quantify the magnitude. Perhaps more importantly, management validated our concern that the shift away from multimodal workloads towards agentic coding (and to a lesser extent token plan mix) had been a headwind for API margins. This makes sense, given M3's value positioning, and low token pricing (which M3.1 will presumably inherit to a large extent). Triangulating management comments saying AI-native gross margins were "slightly" lower than average, we think API gross margins were around 20% this quarter... but skewed towards higher multimodal and lower agentic coding margins - with token plan usage generating the lowest margins across Minimax's business portfolio.

According to our discussions with Minimax, coding had already become a majority share of the company's API revenues in H1. When we asked when and under what circumstances coding margins might rise above multimodal, meaning mix shift away from multimodal ceases to be a gross margin headwind, the answer was once again pinned on a successful M3 Pro release helping to raise blended token pricing. In the meantime, H3 and H3.1 traction could potentially cause multimodal mix to bounce, which would be positive incrementally for inference margins. But the former may well be temporary, and as coding grows faster into a much larger TAM.

Looking ahead to the next couple of months, we'd expect Minimax's shares to remain a referendum on the changes of a narrative-changing M3 Pro release that takes the company back to the frontier.

Exhibit 3 shows a summary of our estimate changes for Minimax. Our latest price target of HK\$320 for Minimax is based on a blend of (1) a lower 3.5x 2029E PS (4.5x previously, lower to reflect the company's lower than expected inference margins), discounted back at 14% annually; and (2) our updated DCF for the company (see Exhibit 4).

EXHIBIT 1: Minimax: Results summary

<u>Minimax H1 2026 results</u>		H1 2026	Delta	Growth YoY
			vs. Bern	Actual
Revenue	Actual	117	-20.3%	283.1%
	Bernstein	146		
Gross profit	Actual	21	-54.8%	464.8%
	Bernstein	46		
Gross margin	Actual	17.9%	-13.6%	5.7%
	Bernstein	31.5%		
GAAP operating profit	Actual	-325	-37.5%	-119.8%
	Bern. Est.	-236		
GAAP operating margin	Actual	-279.0%	-117.2%	207.4%
	Bern. Est.	-161.8%		
Non-GAAP net profit	Actual	-293	-116.4%	-111.2%
	Bernstein	-135		

Source: Corporate reports, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 2: **Minimax: Results by segment**

<u>Segment revenue</u>	<u>Actual</u> <u>H1 2026</u>	<u>Growth</u> <u>YoY</u>	<u>Bernstein</u> <u>H1 2026</u>	<u>Delta</u>
Total revenue	117	283.1%	146	-20.3%
AI-native products	43	100.9%	42	0.4%
Open Platform	74	703.1%	104	-28.7%

<u>Segment revenue</u>	<u>Actual</u> <u>H1 2026</u>	<u>Growth</u> <u>YoY</u>
Total revenue	117	283.1%
Chinese mainland	46	433.7%
Rest of the World	71	224.0%

Source: Corporate reports, Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 3: **Minimax: Summary of estimate changes**

Minimax: summary of estimate changes	2026E	2027E	2028E
Revenue			
Bernstein - Old	419	1,005	2,217
Growth YoY	430.2%	139.8%	120.6%
Bernstein - New	594	2,054	3,749
Growth YoY	651.0%	246.0%	82.6%
Consensus	364	1,001	2,185
Growth YoY	360.2%	175.2%	118.3%
New vs. old	41.6%	104.3%	69.1%
New vs. consensus	63.2%	105.2%	71.6%
GAAP operating income			
Bernstein - Old	-450	-540	-398
Growth YoY	60.2%	19.9%	-26.2%
Margin	-107.4%	-53.7%	-18.0%
Bernstein - New	-762	-915	-1,094
Growth YoY	171.0%	20.2%	19.6%
Margin	-128.3%	-44.6%	-29.2%
Consensus	-594	-650	-470
Growth YoY	111.2%	9.5%	-27.8%
Margin	-163.2%	-64.9%	-21.5%
New vs. old	69.2%	69.5%	174.8%
New vs. consensus	28.3%	40.7%	133.0%
Non-GAAP net income			
Bernstein - Old	-322	-480	-266
Growth YoY	28.4%	49.1%	-44.6%
Margin	-76.8%	-47.8%	-12.0%
Bernstein - New	-682	-792	-870
Growth YoY	171.8%	16.2%	9.8%
Margin	-114.9%	-38.6%	-23.2%
Consensus	-482	-523	-324
Growth YoY	92.2%	8.5%	-38.0%
Margin	-132.5%	-52.2%	-14.8%
New vs. old	111.7%	65.0%	227.3%
New vs. consensus	41.5%	51.5%	168.2%

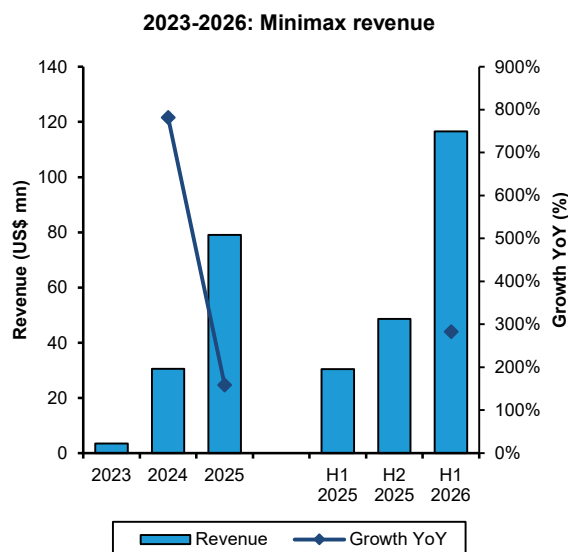
Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 4: **Minimax: DCF valuation**

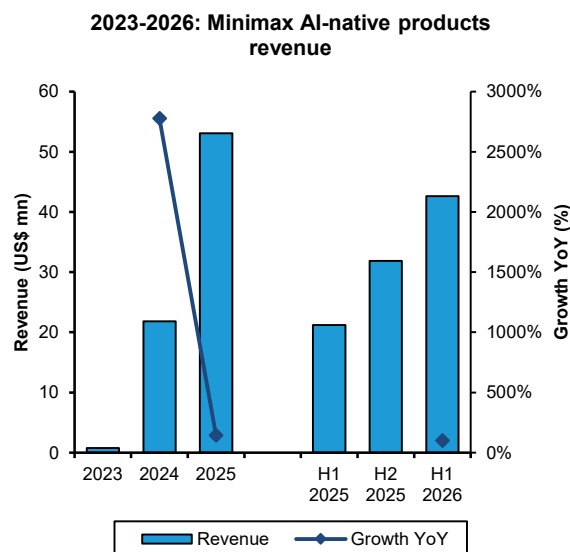
		Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.	Est.
USD mn	2025	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	2031	2032	2033	2034	2035
Revenue	79	594	2,054	3,749	6,030	9,035	11,836	14,203	15,908	17,180	17,696
Growth YoY		651.0%	246.0%	82.6%	60.8%	49.8%	31.0%	20.0%	12.0%	8.0%	3.0%
Gross profit	20	205	709	1,322	2,248	3,580	5,065	6,529	7,818	8,989	9,821
% of revenue	25.4%	34.6%	34.5%	35.3%	37.3%	39.6%	42.8%	46.0%	49.1%	52.3%	55.5%
R&D expenses	-253	-847	-1,453	-2,102	-2,733	-3,416	-4,409	-5,211	-5,746	-6,110	-6,194
% of revenue	-319.0%	-142.7%	-70.7%	-56.1%	-45.3%	-37.8%	-37.2%	-36.7%	-36.1%	-35.6%	-35.0%
Other operating expenses	-48	-120	-171	-314	-506	-760	-938	-1,058	-1,108	-1,114	-1,062
% of revenue	-60.8%	-20.2%	-8.3%	-8.4%	-8.4%	-8.4%	-7.9%	-7.4%	-7.0%	-6.5%	-6.0%
Profit/(loss) from operations	-281	-762	-915	-1,094	-992	-596	-282	261	964	1,766	2,566
% of revenue	-355.6%	-128.3%	-44.6%	-29.2%	-16.4%	-6.6%	-2.4%	1.8%	6.1%	10.3%	14.5%
Less: Income tax	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	-39	-145	-265	-385
Effective tax rate %		15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%	15.0%
NOPAT	-281	-762	-915	-1,094	-992	-596	-282	222	819	1,501	2,181
Depreciation & amortization costs	1	5	20	44	73	113	157	195	226	248	262
Change in net working capital	6	49	169	308	496	743	973	1,167	1,307	1,412	1,454
Capital expenditure	-1	-9	-31	-56	-90	-136	-178	-213	-239	-258	-265
Additions to intangibles	0	-2	-7	-13	-20	-31	-40	-48	-54	-58	-60
Free cash flow	-275	-719	-764	-812	-534	93	630	1,324	2,060	2,845	3,572
% of revenue	-348.2%	-121.1%	-37.2%	-21.6%	-8.8%	1.0%	5.3%	9.3%	13.0%	16.6%	20.2%
WACC	14.3%										
Terminal growth rate	3.0%										
Discount factor		0.3	1.3	2.3	3.3	4.3	5.3	6.3	7.3	8.3	9.3
Present value of FCF - per share		-0.7	-1.9	-1.7	-1.0	0.1	0.9	1.6	2.1	2.5	2.7
Sum of discounted cash flows - per share	5										
NPV of terminal value - per share	25										
Enterprise value per share (US\$)	30										
Less: minority interest - per share	0										
Add: adj. net cash/debt - per share	6										
Equity value per share (US\$)	36										
Equity value per share (HK\$)	279										
Implied 12-month forward price (HK\$)	318										
Upside/downside	5.1%										

Source: Corporate reports and Bernstein analysis.

H1 2026 RESULTS IN CHARTS

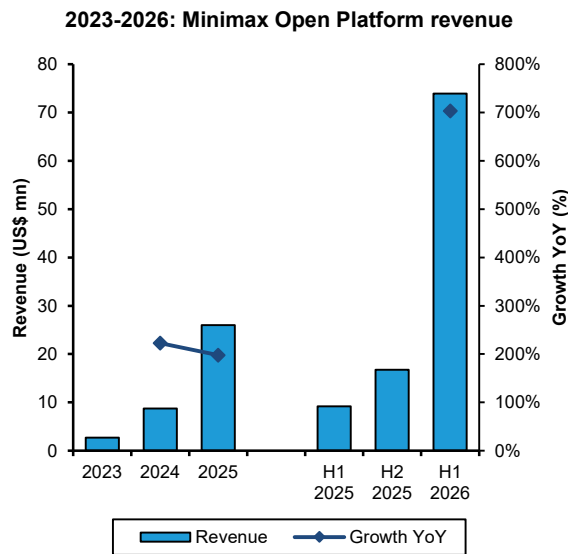
EXHIBIT 5: **Minimax revenue grew 283% in H1 2026 to \$117mn**

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 6: **Revenue from AI-native products reached \$43mn, up 101% year on year**

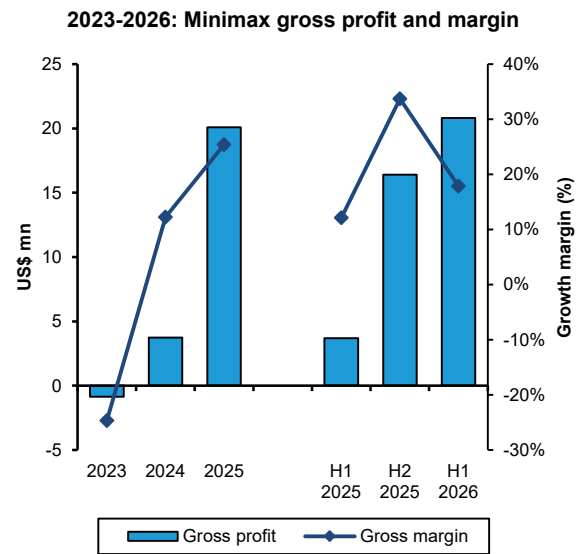
Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 7: Open Platform revenue grew 703% to \$74mn in H1 2026



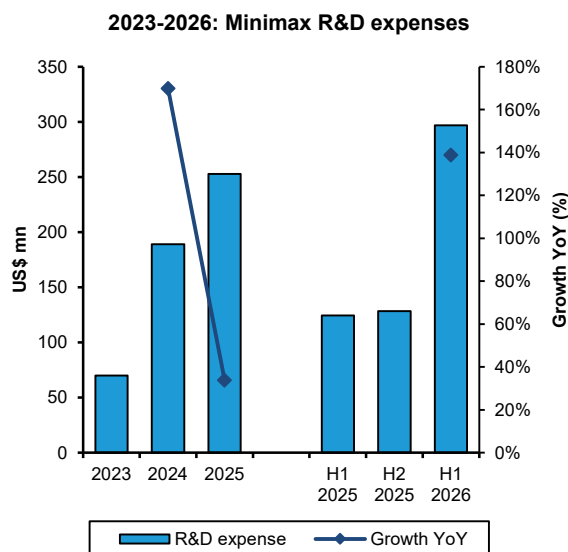
Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 8: Minimax's gross profit reached \$21mn, implying a 17.9% margin



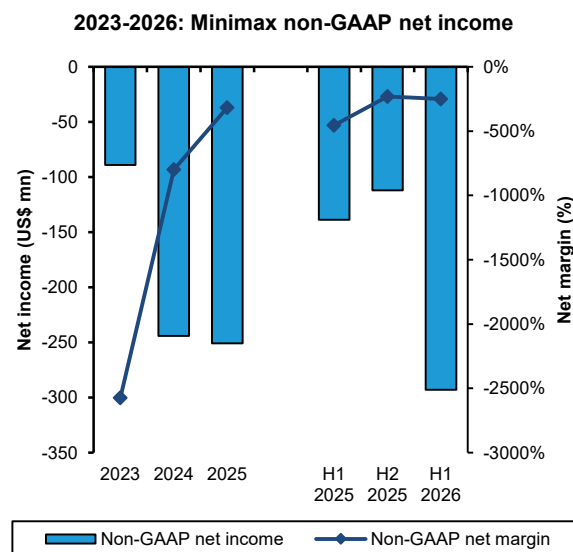
Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 9: R&D expenses increased 139% to \$297mn in H1 2026



Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 10: Minimax's non-GAAP net loss was \$293mn in H1 2026, implying a negative 251% margin



Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

APPENDIX - FINANCIAL FORECASTS

EXHIBIT 11: Minimax: Income Statement

USD mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Revenue	3	31	79	594	2,054	3,749	6,030	9,035
Gross profit	-1	4	20	205	709	1,322	2,248	3,580
Selling & marketing expenses	-23	-87	-52	-58	-74	-136	-219	-328
General & administrative expenses	-8	-14	-37	-70	-97	-178	-288	-432
Research and development expenses	-70	-189	-253	-847	-1,453	-2,102	-2,733	-3,416
Other items	9	36	40	8	0	0	0	0
Loss from operations	-92	-250	-281	-762	-915	-1,094	-992	-596
Profit before tax	-269	-465	-1,872	-795	-916	-1,095	-992	-597
Income tax expense	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Net income	-269	-465	-1,872	-795	-916	-1,095	-992	-597
Net profit attributable to SHs	-269	-465	-1,872	-795	-916	-1,095	-992	-597
Non-GAAP net profit attributable to SHs	-89	-244	-251	-682	-792	-870	-630	-55
Non-GAAP EPS per share - diluted (USD)	-0.85	-2.25	-2.31	-2.11	-2.31	-2.51	-1.79	-0.15

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 12: Minimax: Cash Flow Statement

USD mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Loss before tax	-269	-465	-1,872	-795	-916	-1,095	-992	-597
Depreciation & amortization	1	2	3	2	9	29	52	86
Changes in working capital	26	14	6	248	726	810	994	1,185
Other	178	191	1,583	76	123	225	362	542
Cash flow from operations	-64	-258	-280	-468	-57	-31	416	1,216
Capex	-1	-1	-1	-6	-21	-37	-60	-90
Other	-40	-431	73	0	0	0	0	0
Cash flow from investments	-40	-431	72	-6	-21	-37	-60	-90
Cash flow from financing	306	771	423	7,491	200	200	200	200
Net effect of exchange rate changes	0	1	3	0	0	0	0	0
Net change in cash	202	83	219	7,017	123	132	556	1,326
Beginning cash	5	206	289	508	7,525	7,647	7,779	8,334
Ending cash	206	289	508	7,525	7,647	7,779	8,334	9,660

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

EXHIBIT 13: Minimax: Balance Sheet

USD mn	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Cash & cash equivalents, term deposits	298	315	521	7,538	7,661	7,792	8,348	9,674
Trade receivables	1	7	11	65	225	410	661	990
Other current assets	20	483	475	475	475	475	475	475
Total current assets	320	806	1,007	8,079	8,361	8,677	9,484	11,139
Property and equipment	1	1	2	7	23	47	79	122
Other non-current assets	4	104	79	90	116	138	174	225
Total assets	324	911	1,088	8,175	8,500	8,862	9,737	11,487
Trade and bills payables	17	51	58	372	1,289	2,321	3,627	5,231
Other current liabilities	646	1,656	3,676	3,676	3,676	3,676	3,676	3,676
Total current liabilities	663	1,708	3,734	4,048	4,965	5,997	7,303	8,907
Other non-current liabilities	3	2	3	5,655	5,655	5,655	5,655	5,655
Total liabilities	666	1,710	3,737	9,703	10,621	11,653	12,958	14,563
Shareholders' equity	-342	-799	-2,648	-1,528	-2,121	-2,791	-3,221	-3,076
Total liabilities & shareholders' equity	324	911	1,088	8,175	8,500	8,862	9,737	11,487

Source: Corporate reports, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			26 Aug 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)			
			Closing Price	Price Target	Rel. Perf.								
Ticker	Rating	Cur				Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E		2025A	2026E	2027E
100.HK (MiniMax)	M	HKD	303.00	320.00	NA	USD	(2.31)	(2.11)	(2.31)		(16.7)	(18.3)	(16.8)
OLD				275.00				(0.97)	(1.36)				
ASIA			1,950.18										

PRICE TARGET CHANGE / ESTIMATE CHANGE IN BOLD

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

References to "Bernstein" or the "Firm" in these disclosures relate to the following entities: Bernstein Institutional Services LLC (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein & Co., LLC (pre April 1, 2024), Bernstein Autonomous LLP, BSG France S.A. (April 1, 2024 onwards), Sanford C. Bernstein (Hong Kong) Limited 盛博香港有限公司, Sanford C. Bernstein (Canada) Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein (India) Private Limited (SEBI registration no. INH000006378), Sanford C. Bernstein (Singapore) Private Limited, Sanford C. Bernstein Japan KK (サンフォード・C・バーンスタイン株式会社) and analysts employed by Société Générale Africa Technologies & Services to produce Bernstein research under a Global Services Agreement in place between Bernstein and Société Générale.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY**MiniMax Group Inc.**

We value Minimax on a combination of 3.5x 2029E PS, discounted back at 14% annualised, and our DCF for the company.

RISKS**MiniMax Group Inc.**

The main upside risk related to Minimax's shares relates to a blockbuster M3 Pro release. The main fundamental downside risks related to Minimax include the speed of enterprise AI adoption in China, and competition from rival AI model developers.

RATINGS DEFINITIONS, BENCHMARKS AND DISTRIBUTION**EQUITY RATINGS DEFINITIONS****Bernstein brand**

The Bernstein brand rates stocks based on forecasts of relative performance for the next 12 months versus the S&P 500 for stocks listed on the U.S. and Canadian exchanges, versus the Bloomberg Europe Developed Markets Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index EUR (EDME) for stocks listed on the European exchanges and emerging markets exchanges outside of the Asia Pacific region, versus the Bloomberg Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index USD (JPL) for stocks listed on the Japanese exchanges, and versus the Bloomberg Asia ex-Japan Large and Mid Cap Price Return Index (ASIAX) for stocks listed on the Asian (ex-Japan) exchanges -unless otherwise specified.

The Bernstein brand has three categories of ratings:

- Outperform: Stock will outpace the market index by more than 15 pp
- Market-Perform: Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/- 15 pp
- Underperform: Stock will trail the performance of the market index by more than 15 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Bernstein research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – common stocks

The Autonomous brand rates common stocks as indicated below. As our benchmarks we use the Bloomberg Europe 600 Financials Price Return Index (E600BK) and Bloomberg Europe Dev Mkt Financials Large and Mid Cap Price Ret Index EUR (EDMFI) index for developed European banks and Payments, the Bloomberg Europe 600 Insurance Price Return Index (E600IN) for European insurers, the S&P 500 and S&P Financials for US banks and Payments coverage, S5LIFE for US Insurance, the S&P Insurance Select Industry (SPSIINS) for US Non-Life Insurers coverage, the Bloomberg Emerging Markets Financials Large, Mid and Small Cap Price Return Index (EMLSF) for emerging market banks and insurers and Payments, and the Bloomberg Japan Financials Large & Mid Cap Price Return Index (JPFILM) for Japanese Financials. Ratings are stated relative to the sector (not the market).

The Autonomous brand has three categories of common stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): Stock will outpace the relevant index by more than 10 pp
- Neutral (N): Stock will perform in line with the market index to within +/-10 pp
- Underperform (UP): Stock will trail the performance of the relevant index by more than 10 pp

Coverage Suspended: Coverage of a company under the Autonomous research brand has been suspended. Ratings and price targets are suspended temporarily, are no longer current, and should therefore not be relied upon.

Not Rated: A rating assigned when the stock cannot be accurately valued, or the performance of the company accurately predicted, at the present time. The covering analyst may continue to publish research reports on the company to update investors on events and developments.

Those denoted as 'Feature' (e.g., Feature Outperform FOP, Feature Under Outperform FUP) are our core ideas.

Not Covered (NC) denotes companies that are not under coverage.

Autonomous brand common stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

Autonomous brand – preferred stocks

The Autonomous brand has three categories of preferred stock ratings:

- Outperform (OP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to outperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Neutral (N): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to perform in line with preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.
- Underperform (UP): The total return of the preferred instrument is expected to underperform preferred securities of other issuers operating in similar sectors or rating categories over the next six months.

Autonomous preferred stock ratings are based on a 6-month time horizon.

AUTONOMOUS CREDIT RESEARCH

Where this report contains investment recommendations for credit instruments, as defined in article 3(1)(35) of the Market Abuse Regulation, the information below is presented to comply with its disclosure requirements.

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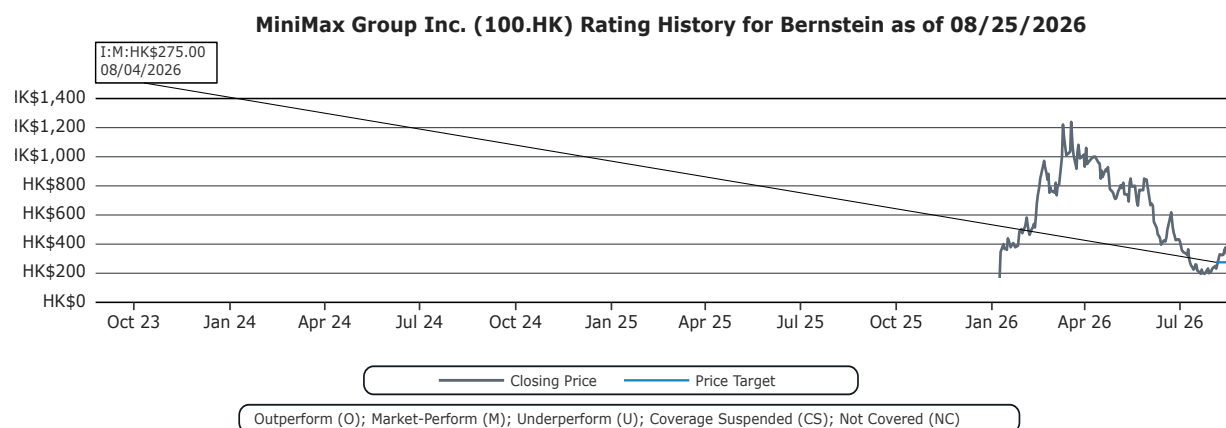
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